



YOU ARE **35 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

30 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Many babies will still have a good volume of amniotic fluid around them, but shadows from the placenta or side of the uterus, coupled with the curled-up fetal position, will make imaging the baby harder and harder.

“It’s a good idea to make practical arrangements now for what might happen if you go into labor.”

With only around four weeks to go, now is the time to make sure you have all your partner’s contact details and know exactly how to get a hold of them in case you go into labour when they are at work. They might discuss with their employer being able to keep their cell phone nearby or minimizing any travel.

If you have other children or other dependents (pets, for example), then you should arrange what will happen to them when you go into the hospital. You may want to explain to any older children what is going to happen so that they are prepared for when they go to stay with Grandma, or whoever will be taking care of them. If you’re having a Cesarean, you might need more help once you are home to care for your older children after you’ve had surgery.

Reassure your children that you will be coming back and that you’re not sick, but that you have to go to the hospital when the baby comes. Depending on the age of your children, you could go with them to buy a present for the baby or you could give them a special job such as opening all the new gifts. Presents from the newborn to elder siblings is also a good gesture.

PAIN RELIEF DURING LABOR

In one study of women who anticipated that they would not need pain relief, 52 percent actually used it.

The best time to talk about pain-relieving options is during your prenatal visits. This will help you set an accurate expectation about pain in labor and how you may cope with it.

ASK A DOCTOR

If my baby is born prematurely and is in the neonatal intensive care unit, is it still helpful to express milk? Yes, definitely. Breast milk helps to ensure that the mother’s natural immunity is passed on to her baby via her milk. Because premature babies are more prone to infection,